Delay Across the Network

2025 U.S. Domestic Flight Reliability

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A national average hides the choices a traveler actually faces: where to depart, when to fly, and which route to take. We built ten D3 views with shared filters and airport drill-down to compare geography, time, reported attribution, and flight volume.

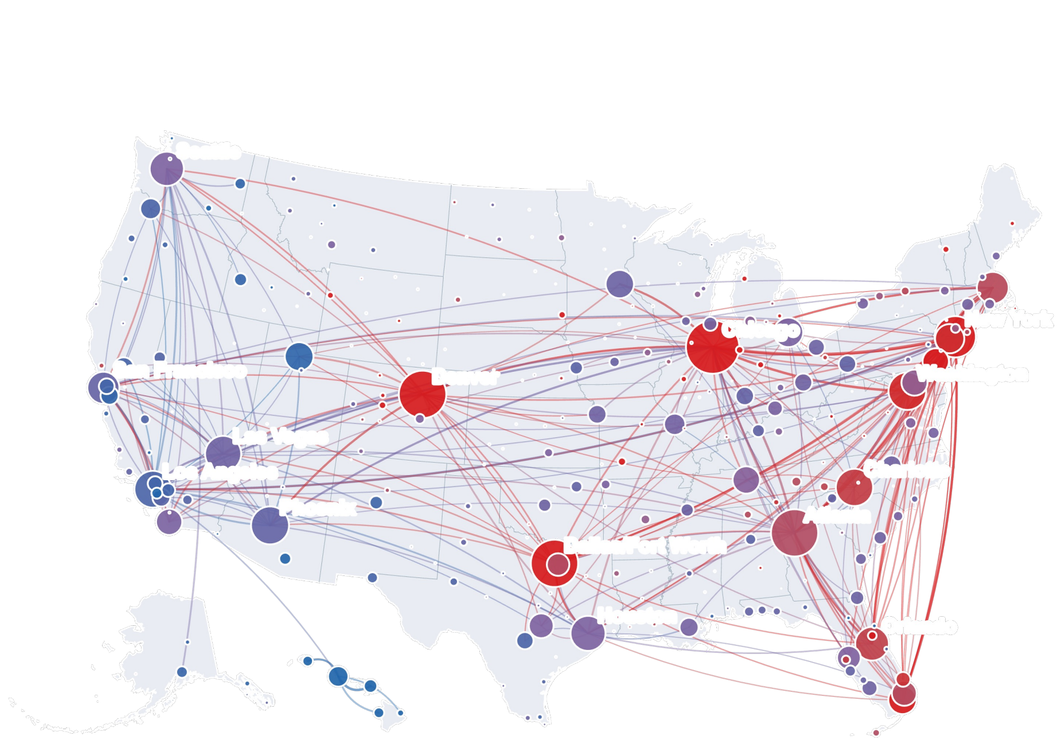
7,001,619
scheduled flight records

22.31%
eligible arrivals delayed ≥15 min

1.47%
scheduled flights cancelled

352 / 14
airports / reporting airlines

01 Where do outcomes differ?



City-network overview. Circle area = departures; color = arrival-delay rate. The 220 busiest visible city pairs pool both directions. 338 of 346 cities are projected; excluded locations remain in national totals. Color is clipped at the 5th/95th percentiles of cities with ≥10,000 departures.

Airport rates span 12.4–30.9%

Among 103 origin airports with ≥10,000 annual departures, Sanford (SFB) has the highest delay rate and Kona (KOA) the lowest.

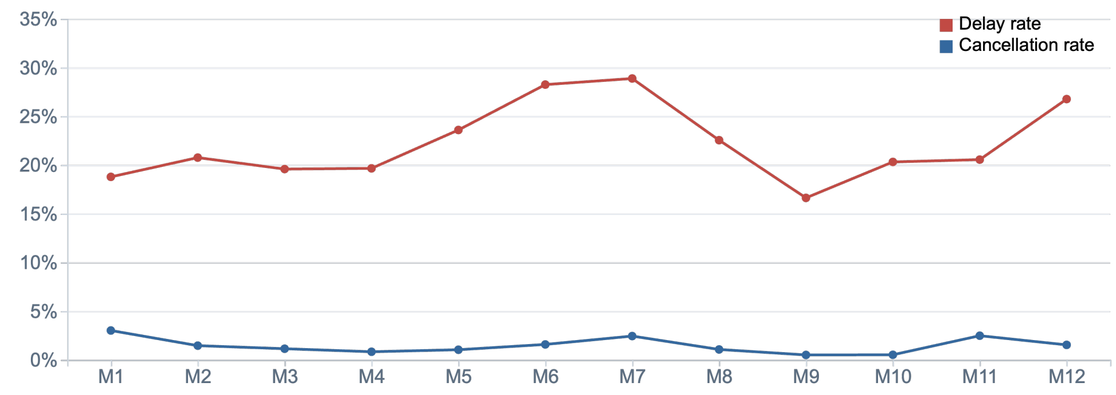
SFB	Sanford	**30.90%**
DFW	Dallas/Fort Worth	**28.67%**
DCA	Washington National	**27.13%**
KOA	Kona	**12.37%**

Busy routes also differ. DCA → HPN: 39.52%; SLC → SUN: 4.48%, among routes with ≥1,000 scheduled flights. Reverse directions are separate.

Airport and city rates refer to arrival outcomes of outgoing flights, not aircraft arriving at the named location.

02 July peaks; September eases

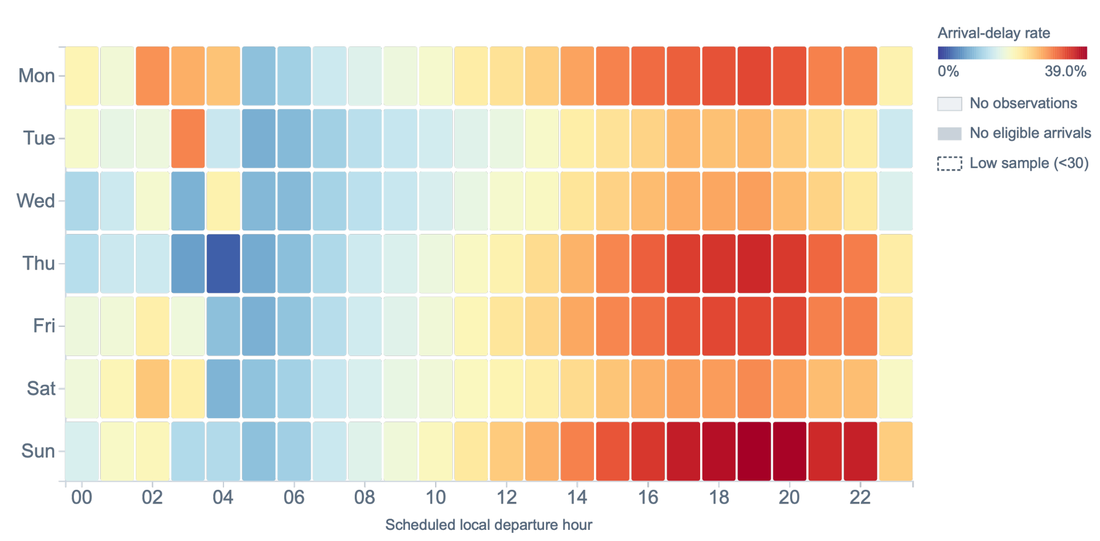
Full year 2025 · all reporting airlines



28.89% in July vs 16.63% in September, a 12.26 percentage-point gap. Cancellations peak separately in January at 3.02%. Red = delay; blue = cancellation; M1–M12 = January–December.

03 Evening departures fare worse

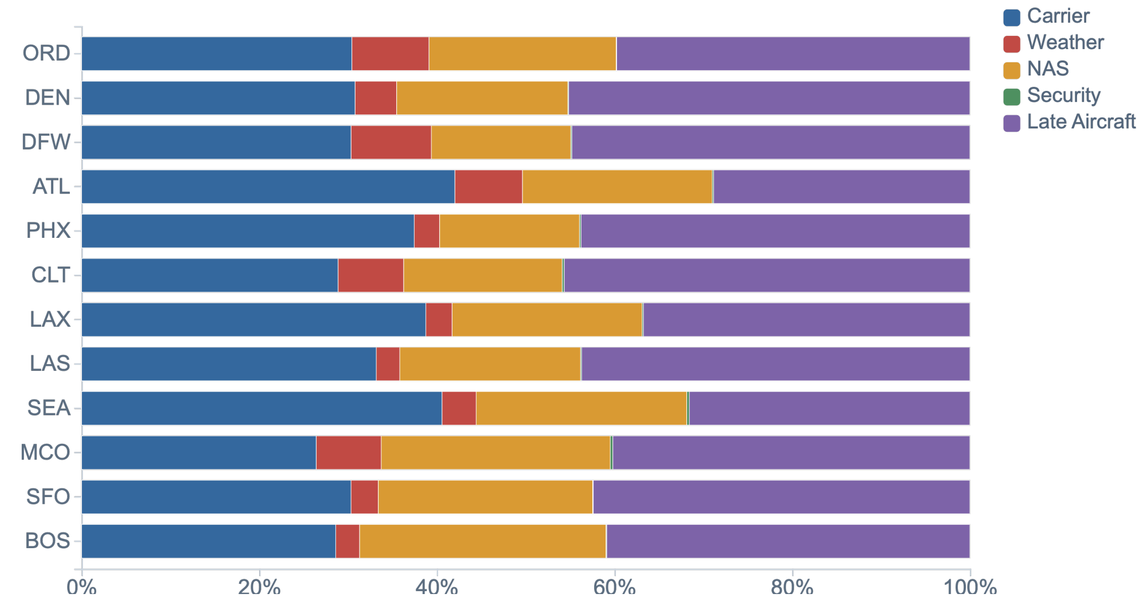
Full year 2025 · all origins · local scheduled time



05:00–08:59: 12.01%; 17:00–20:59: 31.82%. These rates pool eligible arrivals across all weekdays. The heatmap shows each weekday/hour cell; dashed cells have fewer than 30 eligible arrivals.

04 What do the reported minutes show?

12 busiest origin airports · share of attributed minutes



Late Aircraft accounts for 39.19% nationally, followed by Carrier (32.45%). Its share differs across busy origins: 45.17% at DEN vs 28.85% at ATL. Bars show minute composition, not flight counts; Weather excludes weather attributed to NAS.

05 Explore the dashboard with us

Choose months + airline → select an airport → compare its trend, causes and outgoing routes. Switch airport/route rankings and minimum samples. In the volume–reliability scatterplot, brush points to highlight a comparison set.

Data and interpretation

We retain all 12 monthly BTS reporting-carrier files, check duplicates and historical airport joins, and pool counts before calculating rates. Delay rate = delayed arrivals / eligible arrivals; eligibility excludes cancellations, diversions and missing arrival delay.

Limits. Reporting carriers only. Rates do not control for route mix or operating conditions; associations do not establish causes. Missing attribution is not zero. The map stays at full-year scope.

Scan. Choose an airport. Tell us:

Which pattern surprised you, and what would you need to know before booking?

Sources: BTS On-Time Performance 2025 + Master Coordinate; project publication snapshot, 17 Oct 2026.